

The Post-Currency Manifesto: Reclaiming the 9-to-1 Workday

9 to 1. One job. No bills. Together.

Introduction — The Problem

We were told that the normal way to live is to work eight hours a day, five days a week, for forty or more years, receive money, and use that money to purchase the necessities of life.

Yet something has gone profoundly wrong.

We work to earn currency, then spend much of what we earn merely to remain able to work. We pay for housing, food, healthcare, electricity, water, transport, education, communications and countless other necessities. When prices rise, our wages often struggle to follow. Inflation silently reduces purchasing power. Debt fills the gap. Credit turns tomorrow's income into today's consumption. The cycle repeats.

For millions of young people, particularly across emerging economies, the problem is even more fundamental: there may not be a job to begin with. A generation can be educated, ambitious and capable while remaining economically excluded.

At the same time, artificial intelligence, robotics and automation are transforming production. Businesses can increasingly produce more with fewer human workers. This technological progress should be liberating humanity from unnecessary labor. Instead, it can produce layoffs, insecurity and anxiety when access to life's essentials remains dependent upon conventional employment and currency income.

And even those who remain employed often experience another form of poverty: the poverty of time.

People spend their best waking hours commuting, working, recovering from work and worrying about the next bill. Families receive exhausted versions of one another. Creativity becomes a weekend activity. Community becomes an afterthought. Life itself becomes something postponed until retirement.

Beyond Bills begins with a different question:

What if the purpose of an economy were not to maximize the circulation of money, but to guarantee the provisioning of human life?

We propose a post-currency direction: a service-based economy organized around productive contribution, technological efficiency, mutual provision and universal access to life's essentials.

Its motto is our blueprint:

I. 9 to 1 — Reclaiming Human Time

The eight-hour workday was an enormous improvement over the brutal working conditions that preceded it. But a historical achievement does not have to become a permanent ceiling.

Technology has changed.

Automation has changed.

Communication has changed.

Knowledge has changed.

Productivity has changed.

Why should our conception of work remain substantially anchored to the industrial age?

Beyond Bills proposes the **9-to-1 workday**: a four-hour period of focused productive contribution, ordinarily from 9:00 a.m. to 1:00 p.m., followed by an afternoon liberated for the rest of human life.

This is not a proposal that every existing job can immediately be compressed into four hours. Nor does it pretend that every form of essential work has identical scheduling requirements. Healthcare, emergency services, infrastructure, agriculture, transportation and other functions may require continuous coverage and carefully coordinated shifts.

The principle is broader:

Human beings should contribute efficiently, not exhaustively.

A four-hour shift creates a powerful incentive to eliminate unnecessary meetings, bureaucratic duplication, idle time, excessive commuting and work that exists merely because the system has normalized it.

Technology should become a force multiplier.

Automation should handle repetitive tasks.

Software should eliminate administrative friction.

Artificial intelligence should augment human judgment and creativity.

Robotics should perform dangerous, exhausting or highly repetitive physical work wherever appropriate.

Networks should coordinate resources across organizations and regions.

The objective is not simply to make workers work faster so that they can produce more for someone else. The objective is to make society productive enough that human beings require less compulsory labor to sustain a high quality of life.

Imagine what four additional hours every afternoon could mean.

A parent could be present when children return home.

A young person could learn music, engineering, agriculture, languages or art.

An inventor could build something without needing to quit their job.

A citizen could participate in local governance.

A neighbor could care for an elderly person.

An athlete could train.

A writer could write.

A community could create.

A family could eat together.

A human being could simply breathe.

The 9-to-1 economy therefore measures prosperity differently. Prosperity is not merely how much we produce. It is also how much **human life remains after production**.

The great promise of technology has always been liberation from unnecessary toil.

Beyond Bills asks us to finally claim that promise.

Four focused hours of contribution. Twenty hours a week as a social baseline where productive conditions permit. The rest of the day belongs to humanity.

II. One Job — Ending the Side-Hustle Economy

The modern economy increasingly tells people that one job is not enough.

Get a second job.

Start a side hustle.

Drive after work.

Freelance at night.

Sell something online.

Monetize your hobby.

Build a personal brand.

Invest whatever remains.

Work while sleeping.

This is frequently presented as entrepreneurship and ambition. Sometimes it genuinely is. But for millions of people, the side-hustle economy is not freedom. It is a survival mechanism.

When one job cannot reliably provide housing, food, healthcare and security, people are pushed to sell additional portions of their lives.

Beyond Bills proposes a radical alternative:

Every adult should have access to exactly one principal productive role.

Not because human beings should be forbidden from creating businesses, volunteering, studying or pursuing projects. Rather, because the basic economic system should not require a person to hold multiple jobs simply to survive.

Your principal job should fit you.

A person with exceptional teaching ability should teach.

A skilled technician should maintain infrastructure.

A gifted programmer should build systems.

A compassionate person with the right training may serve in care work.

An analytical mind may contribute to research, planning or administration.

A creative person may contribute through design, media, architecture or the arts.

A farmer may produce food.

An engineer may maintain the machinery that makes production possible.

A coordinator may connect resources that would otherwise remain idle.

The objective is **ability-suited labor allocation**.

Instead of forcing millions of people into whatever job happens to be available, the network would continuously seek to match people with roles according to skills, aptitudes, education, experience, preferences and the needs of society.

This changes the meaning of employment.

Employment becomes a form of **social contribution**, not merely a transaction for purchasing power.

The economy would maintain a living map of essential functions: food, housing, healthcare, education, sanitation, energy, water, transport, technology, manufacturing, communications, environmental stewardship, public administration and countless other services.

Where there is a shortage of workers, the network identifies it.

Where there is an oversupply, the network identifies that too.

Where automation can replace repetitive human labor, people can be redirected toward roles where human judgment, creativity, care and responsibility matter more.

The result is not a promise that everyone gets their dream occupation. Society still has unpleasant, difficult and necessary work. But it is a commitment to organize labor intelligently, distribute necessary responsibilities fairly and continuously improve working conditions.

A person should not have to maintain three income streams simply because the economic system has failed to coordinate society's productive capacity.

Nor should unemployment mean social uselessness.

If technology eliminates a person's former role, that person should be redirected toward another socially valuable contribution, retrained where necessary and guaranteed access to life's essentials during the transition.

The **One Job** principle therefore rests on three commitments:

One person. One principal productive role. One fair contribution.

The economic network carries the responsibility of making sure that essential work is covered without requiring every individual to compete desperately for multiple sources of income.

We reject the idea that a successful economy is one in which people are perpetually hustling.

We want an economy in which people are **usefully engaged, adequately provisioned and free to live.**

III. No Bills — From Currency Transactions to Direct Provisioning

This is the heart of the **Beyond Bills** thesis.

Currency is useful. It provides a common medium of exchange, facilitates accounting and allows people who produce different things to coordinate economically.

But currency is also a middleman.

You work.

Your work generates value.

You receive currency.

You use currency to obtain housing.

You use currency to obtain food.

You use currency to obtain healthcare.

You use currency to obtain electricity.

You use currency to obtain education.

You use currency to obtain water.

You use currency to obtain transportation.

The currency itself does not house you, feed you, heal you or educate you.

It merely represents a claim that can potentially be exchanged for those things.

That distinction matters.

If the purpose of economic production is ultimately to provide goods and services, why must every essential service pass through an increasingly complicated chain of monetary transactions before reaching the person who needs it?

Beyond Bills proposes a different model: **direct value exchange through a coordinated service network.**

Under the One Job principle, an adult contributes approximately four focused hours of socially useful work. In return, the network guarantees a **Life Essentials Package.**

The package is not simply a cash payment.

It is provision.

It can include, according to the capacity and standards of the participating network:

- **Housing**
- **Nutrition and essential food**
- **Healthcare**
- **Water and sanitation**
- **Essential utilities and energy**
- **Basic transportation access**
- **Education and lifelong learning**
- **Digital connectivity**
- **Other foundational services necessary for dignified living**

The exact package would evolve according to technological capacity, local conditions, ecological limits and democratic or participatory decision-making.

The fundamental principle is simple:

Work should provision life directly.

This does not mean that every luxury, preference or specialized product becomes universally available without limitation. A society must still account for scarcity, environmental constraints, specialized skills and genuine differences in demand.

But the essentials required for a dignified human existence should not depend upon whether an individual can accumulate enough currency to purchase them.

The system would therefore need an entirely different form of accounting.

Instead of asking only, "How much money does this person have?", the network asks:

What services are available? Who needs them? Who can provide them? Where are the shortages? Where are the surpluses? What resources must move between regions?

This creates a service-based economic map.

Consider housing.

One enterprise may construct homes.

Another may manufacture building materials.

Another may provide architectural services.

Another may manage maintenance.

Another may provide energy.

Another may provide water infrastructure.

Rather than every household separately navigating a chain of financial obligations, these organizations participate in a wider provisioning network.

The same logic applies to food.

Farmers produce.

Processors transform.

Transport networks distribute.

Retail or community provisioning centers deliver.

Nutrition systems monitor availability and demand.

Healthcare providers serve.

Technology coordinates.

Every participating organization both **receives essential services from the network and contributes services back into it.**

This creates what **Beyond Bills** calls **corporate loops.**

A housing enterprise needs construction materials, electricity, software, transport, workers and maintenance.

A food enterprise needs agricultural inputs, machinery, logistics, energy and technology.

A healthcare organization needs buildings, medical equipment, pharmaceuticals, digital infrastructure, utilities and trained professionals.

No company exists in isolation.

Each becomes a node in a larger provisioning ecosystem.

At the local level, communities can provide many essentials themselves.

At the regional level, specialized production can be shared.

At the global level, resources and expertise can move across borders to compensate for geographic differences.

A country without certain minerals can obtain them through the network.

A region with abundant agricultural capacity can support regions with less productive land.

A technologically advanced company can provide systems to communities that lack the capacity to develop them independently.

The objective is not autarky.

It is **interdependence without deprivation**.

Currency may continue to exist during the transition and may remain useful for discretionary markets, external trade or non-essential goods. **Beyond Bills** does not require humanity to abolish money overnight.

The post-currency economy is instead a direction:

Move essential provisioning away from dependence on monetary income and toward direct participation in a coordinated service economy.

The ultimate measure of economic success becomes radically different.

Not:

"How much money did you make?"

But:

"How effectively did we provision one another?"

Not:

"Can you afford to survive?"

But:

"Can the network guarantee that you are housed, nourished, healthy, educated and connected?"

Not:

"How many hours can we extract from workers?"

But:

"How much essential value can society create with the least necessary human labor?"

That is the meaning of **No Bills**.

It is not a promise that scarcity disappears.

It is a promise that we should stop confusing **money with the things money is supposed to obtain**.

IV. Together — Building the Global Network

No economic transformation can be accomplished by an idea alone.

It requires people.

It requires organizations.

It requires infrastructure.

It requires experimentation.

It requires trust.

And it requires time.

Beyond Bills therefore begins not as a government, a bank or a corporation attempting to command the world. It begins as an **ideological think tank and movement** dedicated to developing, testing and communicating the post-currency economic vision.

Our task is to make the alternative imaginable, discussable and eventually demonstrable.

Beyond Bills will build global chapters capable of studying local economic conditions, engaging communities, developing partnerships and identifying organizations that can participate in service-based provisioning.

The movement will connect people who believe that technological progress should reduce compulsory labor rather than merely increase unemployment.

It will connect companies willing to explore new models of mutual provision.

It will connect researchers, economists, engineers, entrepreneurs, educators, farmers, healthcare professionals, designers, policymakers and community organizers.

The network must begin with ideas, but it cannot end there.

The long-term objective is to create a **self-sustaining economic moat**: a dense network of individuals and organizations whose mutual dependence makes the service economy increasingly capable of provisioning its participants.

Imagine thousands of companies connected through reciprocal service agreements.

Imagine millions of adults contributing one principal job.

Imagine regional networks sharing food, housing capacity, healthcare, energy, technology and expertise.

Imagine companies no longer viewing workers merely as costs and consumers merely as sources of revenue, but as participants in a common provisioning ecosystem.

Imagine a person joining the network and knowing that their contribution gives them a recognized place within that ecosystem.

That is **Together**.

The network cannot be built through coercion. It must demonstrate value.

Participation must become attractive because the system works.

Trust must be earned through transparency.

Standards must be measurable.

Resources must be accounted for.

Service quality must be monitored.

Abuse and free-riding must be addressed.

Governance must prevent the network from becoming another concentration of economic power.

The transition must therefore be experimental and incremental.

Pilot communities can test service packages.

Partner companies can experiment with shorter work schedules.

Technology platforms can coordinate contributions and provisioning.

Researchers can measure productivity, wellbeing, resource use and economic resilience.

Successful models can be replicated.

Failed models can be corrected.

Every chapter becomes a laboratory.

Every partner becomes part of the learning process.

Every participant becomes evidence that another economic relationship is possible.

Beyond Bills does not claim that the world can simply wake up tomorrow and eliminate currency.

The existing economy is deeply interconnected with monetary systems, governments, property rights, taxation, banking, international trade and legal institutions.

The transition must therefore be evolutionary where necessary and revolutionary in imagination.

We build parallel capacity.

We prove new possibilities.

We expand what works.

We invite existing institutions to participate.

And eventually, if the service network becomes sufficiently productive and comprehensive, dependence on monetary exchange for life's essentials can progressively decline.

The ultimate network is global but not necessarily centralized.

A village should retain meaningful local capacity.

A city should coordinate its own essential systems.

Regions should specialize where appropriate.

Countries should cooperate.

Companies should contribute.

Individuals should participate.

Technology should connect the layers.

The network should be **distributed, interoperable and accountable**.

Together does not mean everyone becomes identical.

It means our differences become complementary.

One person grows food.

Another builds software.

Another teaches.

Another repairs machines.

Another cares for children.

Another designs homes.

Another maintains water systems.

Another advances medical science.

Another coordinates logistics.

Another creates art.

Different contributions.

Shared civilization.

That is the economic relationship we seek to build.

Not dependency on a paycheck. Interdependency through provision.

V. The Call to Action — Join the Movement

The future will not be built by waiting for someone else to invent it.

If you believe that technology should give humanity more life rather than simply more productivity, join us.

If you believe that one meaningful job should be enough to secure life's essentials, join us.

If you believe that housing, nutrition, healthcare, education, utilities and other necessities should be treated primarily as services to be provisioned rather than commodities people must constantly struggle to purchase, join us.

If you believe that the four-hour workday deserves serious experimentation, join us.

If you are an individual who wants to contribute ideas, skills, research or time, join us.

If you represent a company willing to explore becoming a **founding service partner**, join us.

If you are a researcher, entrepreneur, engineer, educator, farmer, healthcare professional, artist, policymaker or community builder who wants to help test the possibilities, join us.

The first step is simple.

Join the **Beyond Bills** community through the online form at beyondbills.github.io/#community.

Provide your **full phone number**, preferably your **WhatsApp number**, your **email address**, and a message explaining your intent, ideas, skills, questions or wishes.

You can also share this manifesto with someone who needs to imagine a different economic future.

And if your organization can provide a service within a future mutual-provision network, identify yourself as a potential **Founding Service Partner**.

We are not merely campaigning against bills.

We are campaigning for an economy in which human beings are no longer required to organize their entire existence around them.

The question is not whether the transition will be easy.

The question is whether the civilization capable of artificial intelligence, robotics, global communications and extraordinary productive abundance is willing to redesign its economic institutions around human freedom.

We believe it is.

We believe the first step begins with an idea.

Then a conversation.

Then a community.

Then a network.

Then a working system.

9 to 1. One job. No bills. Together.

Beyond Bills.

Let's build the post-currency economy.